JACOB AFO

Business Development Manager · Product Strategy · Applied AI in Financial Services

Enugu, Nigeria | +234 703 748 6085 | afojacob@gmail.com | https://linkedin.com/in/j003 | website: https://afojacob.github.io

PROFILE

Business and technology leader with 7+ years building distribution models, digital products and data-led growth strategy across Nigeria's banking and fintech sector. Currently leads National agent and merchant business development at Redtech Limited, after 3+ years scaling First Bank of Nigeria's agent network past 57,000 active agents and managing a ₦5–6 billion portfolio. Combines commercial leadership with technical depth, building financial products that widen access and create economic opportunity in emerging markets.

CORE STRENGTHS

Business Development & Channel Growth · Product Strategy & Roadmapping · Financial Inclusion & Digital Banking · Data-Driven Decision Making (Power BI, Excel, SQL) · Applied AI in Financial Services · Cross-Functional & Team Leadership

57,000+ Active agents supported	**9,975+** Merchants onboarded in one year	**₦5–6B** Portfolio managed
20% Growth in transaction value	**40%** Faster onboarding & activation	**7+** Years in banking & digital finance

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Business Development Manager/National DSA Lead — Redtech Limited *May 2026 – Present*

Leads national agent and merchant business development, driving team productivity and transaction growth while ensuring regulatory and operational compliance.

- Manage and coordinate 47 Direct Sales Agents (DSAs) for Direct merchant and agent acquisition, engagement and terminal deployment across the country.
- Set and drive National sales targets, accelerating transaction volume and value
- Own regulatory and operational compliance across all field operations
- Onboard 3,614 customers and deployed 1,014 POS between June to September, 2026

Regional Product Manager – Agent & Merchant Business — First Bank of Nigeria Ltd. *Jan 2024 – May 2026*

- Onboarded 9,975 new merchants in one year, grew active agent base to 57,000 and strengthening coverage in underserved regions
- Improved transaction growth by 20% through payment flow optimisation and targeted agent enablement
- Designed activation programmes that lifted monthly active agent rates by 15–20%, improving network reliability and stability
- Partnered with engineering, compliance, operations and marketing to deliver scalable, compliant digital solutions
- Cut onboarding and activation timelines by 40% through process redesign and standardisation

Regional Product Manager – E-Business & Retail Products — First Bank of Nigeria Ltd. *Feb 2023 – Jan 2024*

- Owned the product roadmap for mobile and agent banking platforms supporting 57,000 agents regionwide
- Partnered with engineering, data and UX teams to improve customer and agent journeys, delivering 14% year-on-year growth in active transacting agents
- Converted market and competitor analysis across fintech and bank-led platforms into product enhancements that lifted usage by 5–8%
- Sustained transaction growth through economic volatility by prioritising high-impact initiatives

Business Relationship Manager – Retail Banking — First Bank of Nigeria Ltd. *Jun 2019 – Feb 2023*

- Managed a ₦5–6 billion retail and SME portfolio, delivering 10–15% growth through structured relationship strategies
- Used customer and transaction data to identify growth opportunities and expand share of wallet
- Acted as the link between customers, product teams and operations, improving service turnaround times by 25%
- Maintained full KYC/AML compliance with zero audit or regulatory issues

Trade Developer — kimberly Ryan Limited. *Jan 2018 – April 2019*

- Managed 700 Firstmonie agents across 14 Branches in Cross River State, Championed acquisitions and activations.
- Strengthened agent engagement and business performance by supervising and coordinating 14 staff (Digittal Geeks) to ensure targets are met.
- Grew Firstmonie agents from 18 to 700 within a year (2018).
- Improved average transaction counts and value by 40% and 60% respectively over 2018.

EDUCATION

MSc, Information Technology — National Open University of Nigeria 2023

BSc, Computer Science — Cross River University of Technology, Nigeria 2016

CERTIFICATIONS & AFFILIATIONS

Artificial Intlligence in Sales and marketing — Oxford Home Study 2026
Data Analytics for Strategic Decision Making — Chartered Institute of Bankers of Nigeria (CIBN), 2025
Associate, Chartered Institute of Bankers of Nigeria (ACIB), 2023
Business Intelligence & Data Analytics — Corporate Finance Institute, 2022
Financial Modeling & Valuation Analyst — Corporate Finance Institute, 2022